



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

prasāra.vīvadhac.chedān muṣṭi.sasya.vadhād api | KAZ13.4.07ab
vamanād gūḍha.ghātāc ca jāyate prakṛti.kṣayaḥ || 7 || KAZ13.4.07cd

— Arthaśāstra, Chapter 4 (Sections 174; 175): Laying Siege to a Fort; Storming a Fort (Chapter 4), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Arthaśāstra, while seemingly focused on worldly governance, offers profound insights applicable to your inner life. This verse, detailing the destructive consequences of siege warfare – spreading discord, cutting off supplies, destroying resources, poisoning, and secret assassinations – speaks not just of physical conflict but of the inner battles we wage against ourselves. The phrase "jāyate prakṛti.kṣayaḥ," meaning "destruction of the constituent elements," is key. This destruction isn't limited to the fort; it's the erosion of our own inner fortresses: our mental peace, emotional stability, and spiritual strength.

Consider your own mind as a kingdom. Negative thoughts are the invading army. Spreading discord (prasāra) is like allowing doubt and fear to sow seeds of division within your consciousness, turning your own thoughts against each other. Cutting off supplies (vīvadhac.chedān) mirrors the denial of self-care, neglecting practices that nourish your soul – meditation, mindful breathing, connection with nature, or creative expression. Destroying resources (muṣṭi.sasya.vadhād api) equates to squandering your energy on unproductive activities, draining your vitality and leaving you vulnerable. Poisoning (vamanād) represents the toxic influences you allow into your life – negative relationships, harmful media, self-deprecating thoughts. Secret assassinations (gūḍha.ghātāc ca) are the insidious self-sabotaging behaviors that undermine your progress, often hidden from your conscious awareness.

The verse warns that these actions lead to the "destruction of the constituent elements" – a disintegration of your inner self. Just as a kingdom falls when its defenses are breached and its resources depleted, your inner peace crumbles when you allow negativity to fester and erode your well-being. The Arthaśāstra, therefore, is not just about conquering external enemies, but about mastering your internal landscape, building a fortress of resilience, and protecting the precious resources of your spirit. By recognizing these destructive patterns in your own life, you can begin to cultivate inner peace and strength.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you identify and dismantle the siege warfare being waged against your own inner peace and well-being today?